



MKTG90011 Marketing Research



Seminar 1

Welcome to Market Research!



<https://www.coca-colacompany.com/about-us/history/new-coke-the-most-memorable-marketing-blunder-ever>

Topics for Today



- 1. What is marketing research and who conducts market research?**
- 2. Subject practicalities and structure**
- 3. The marketing research process**



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What is Marketing Research and who Conducts Market Research?

What is Marketing Research?



Marketing research is the function that links the consumer, customer, and public to the marketer through **information**—information used to identify and define opportunities and problems; generate, refine, and evaluate actions; monitor performance; and improve understanding of it as a process. It specifies the information required to address these issues, designs the method for collecting information, manages and implements the data collection process, analyzes the results, and communicates the findings and their implications.

(American Marketing Association 2017).

Facebook.com/Ogilvy

Advertising people who ignore research are as dangerous as generals who ignore decodes of enemy signals.

David Ogilvy

Careers in Marketing Research



Market researcher salary in Australia

How much does a Market Researcher make in Australia?

Average base salary ?

\$88,074 Per year ▼

The average salary for a market researcher is \$88,074 per year in Australia. 42 salaries reported, updated at 17 February 2025

Job opportunities

2,695

Jobs in Australia right now

Salary

N/A

Typical salary in Australia

Job growth

↑ 11.4%

5-year projection

Source 1: <https://au.indeed.com/career/market-researcher/salaries>
Source 2: <https://www.seek.com.au/career-advice/role/market-researcher>

How to become a marketing researcher?



1. Consider studying a Bachelor of Business, Management, Economics or Commerce with a major in marketing. These courses will take you 3 years to complete full-time.
2. Alternatively, consider a Bachelor of Statistics, Psychology, Sociology, Economics, Behavioural Sciences or Computer Science degrees. These are less common pathways, but may help you to specialise in particular industries.
3. Consider joining the Australian Market & Social Research Society to keep up with industry trends and developments.

Statistics +

Client Engagement +

Social Sciences +

Market Research +

Microsoft PowerPoint +

Data Analysis +

Project Management +

Research Projects +

Punctual +

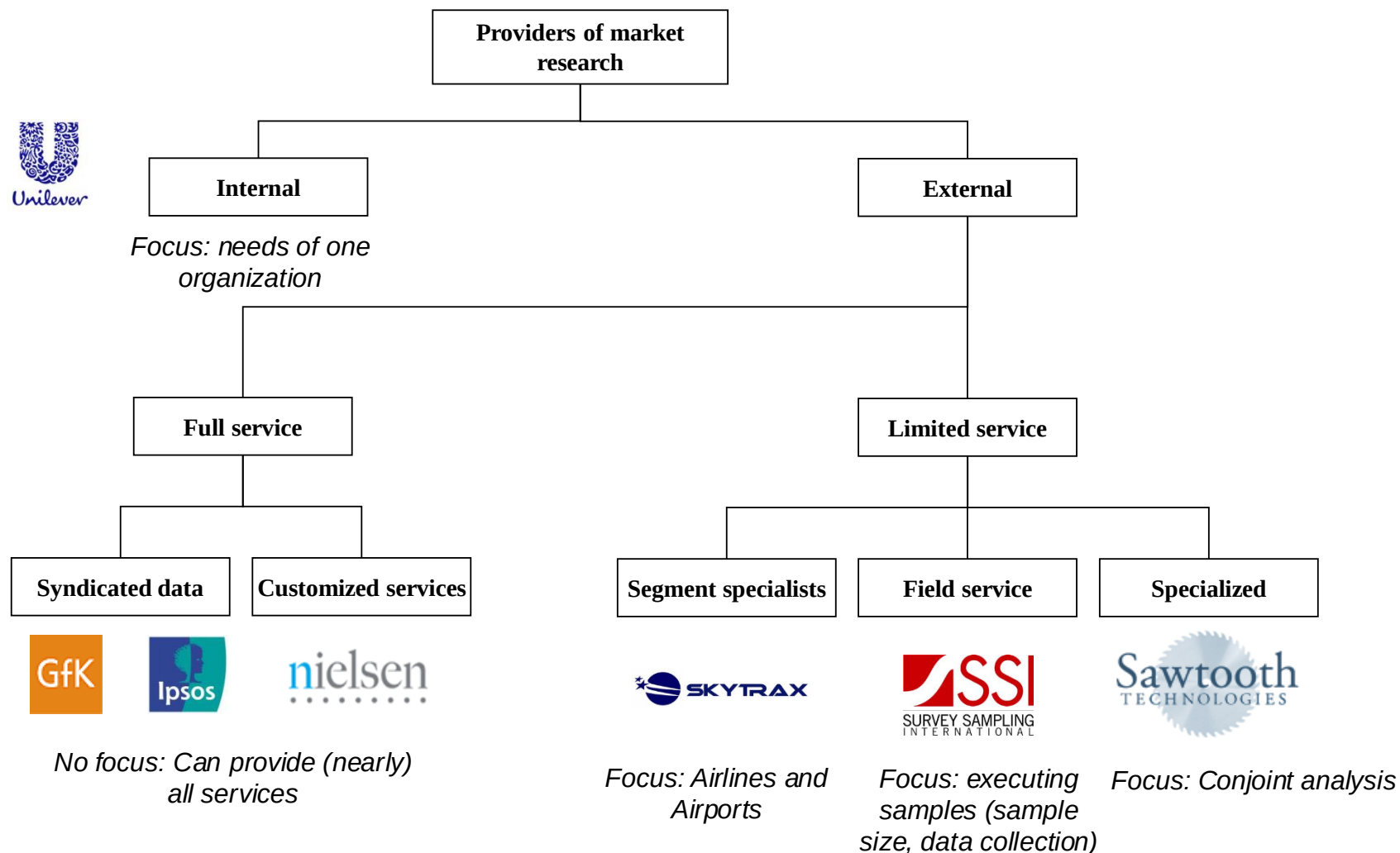
Problem Solving +

What do market researchers do? (Seek.com)



1. Meeting with clients to agree project scope and timeline.
2. Writing and managing the distribution of surveys.
3. Briefing research teams and managing survey staff.
4. Managing project budgets.
5. Conducting qualitative, quantitative and ethnographic research, such as surveys, interviews, focus groups and observations.
6. Using statistical modelling software.
7. Organising, managing and storing data and information.
8. Analysing data and interpreting patterns.
9. Writing reports and presenting data-driven results.
10. Consulting with clients on how to best utilise the findings.

Who Provides Market Research?



Leading Marketing Research Industry Organizations



- Australian Market and Social Research Society (AMSRS)
<https://researchsociety.com.au/>
- Asia Pacific Research Committee (ARPC) <https://aprc-research.com/>
- American Marketing Association (AMA) <https://www.ama.org/>
- Market Research Institute International (MRII) <https://mrii.org/>
- European Society for Opinion and Marketing Research (ESOMAR)
<https://www.esomar.org/>

Subject Practicalities & Structure

Intro to your teaching team



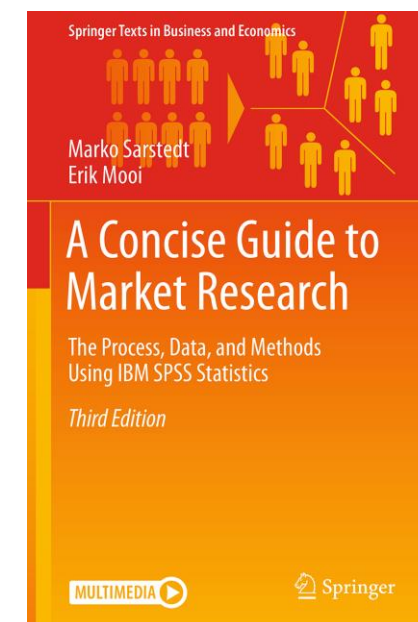
- **Coordinator: Dr. Yi-Lin Tsai**
- **Lecturers: Dr. Stephanie Kwari and Dr. Carolyn Lo**

Day	Time from	Time to	Building	Room Number	Instructor	Section
Monday	12:00	15:00	The Spot	PAR-110-L5-5008-Lecture Theatre (85)	Dr Yi-Lin TSAI	4
Tuesday	12:00	15:00	The Spot	PAR-110-L4-4014-Lectorial Learning Space (79)	Dr Yi-Lin TSAI	3
Tuesday	15:00	18:00	The Spot	PAR-110-L4-4012-Lectorial Learning Space (86)	Dr Stephanie KWARI	2
Thursday	17:00	20:00	The Spot	PAR-110-L4-4012-Lectorial Learning Space (86)	Dr Stephanie KWARI	5
Tuesday	12:00	15:00	Harold White Theatre	PAR-199-L1-124-Harold White Theatre (103)	Dr Carolyn LO	1
Tuesday	18:00	21:00	Harold White Theatre	PAR-199-L1-124-Harold White Theatre (103)	Dr Carolyn LO	6

Subject structure and resources



- Format: 3-hour Seminar
 - 1.5-hour lecture
 - 1.5-hour activities/workshop (e.g., exercises, SPSS)
- Resources
 - All LMS (e.g., slides, interview videos)
 - Seminars
 - Recommended textbook: A Concise Guide to Market Research
- Software
 - Qualtrics: a questionnaire design tool
 - IBM SPSS Statistics (SPSS): statistical software



Assessment



Quizzes	Individual	10%
Final Exam	Individual	50%
Project	Group	40%
Total		100%

Individual: Quizzes (10%)



- **5 Quizzes (each 2%) to help you review the materials**
 - Questions are closely related to the lectures and workshops.
 - Non-cumulative
 - Once you start the quiz, you have one hour to complete it.
 - You can use these questions to prepare for your final exam.
- **Released on Thursday at 11:59 pm and closed on Tuesday at 11:59 pm**

Individual: Final Exam (50%)



- Open book – you can take the book and notes with you.
- Details and a sample exam will be made available to you later.

Group: Project (40%)



- **Form a group of 4 to 5**
 - Group mates in the **SAME** section
 - Choose your own group in W1 and W2
 - We will help you if you cannot find a group
- **Deliverables**
 - Research Questions and Survey Design 2% (W6)
 - Write-up 33% (W12)
 - PowerPoint slides 5% (W12)
- More details to follow

Project: Consumer Perception and Purchase of Dietary Supplements



Market Size & Growth

- The Australian dietary supplement market is valued at AU\$1.7 billion.



Consumer Spending Trends

- Young adults are among the highest spenders, averaging AU\$56 per month on supplements.



Role of E-Commerce & Digital Marketing

- Consumers heavily rely on social media influencers, online reviews, and digital platforms like Chemist Warehouse, iHerb, and Amazon Australia for purchase decisions.

Project: Consumer Perception and Purchase of Dietary Supplements (cont.)



Consumer Concerns

- Persistent concerns about trust, misinformation, and regulatory oversight.
- Hesitations stem from doubts over product quality, potential side effects, and the overwhelming variety of available options.



Regulation by Therapeutic Goods Administration (TGA)

- Reports of adverse effects, such as peripheral neuropathy linked to excessive vitamin B6 intake, have led to TGA-issued safety alerts.



Management Decision Problem

How can supplement brands grow while effectively educating consumers and promoting safe supplement use?

Action map to the project



Form a group.



Determine your research question(s).



Conduct a literature review and secondary data research.



Conduct qualitative research (e.g., in-depth interviews, focus groups, or observations).



Analyse the qualitative research data.



Design a **survey questionnaire** based on previous steps.



Collect data.



Analyse the quantitative data and interpret findings.



Write a **report** and design a **PowerPoint presentation**.

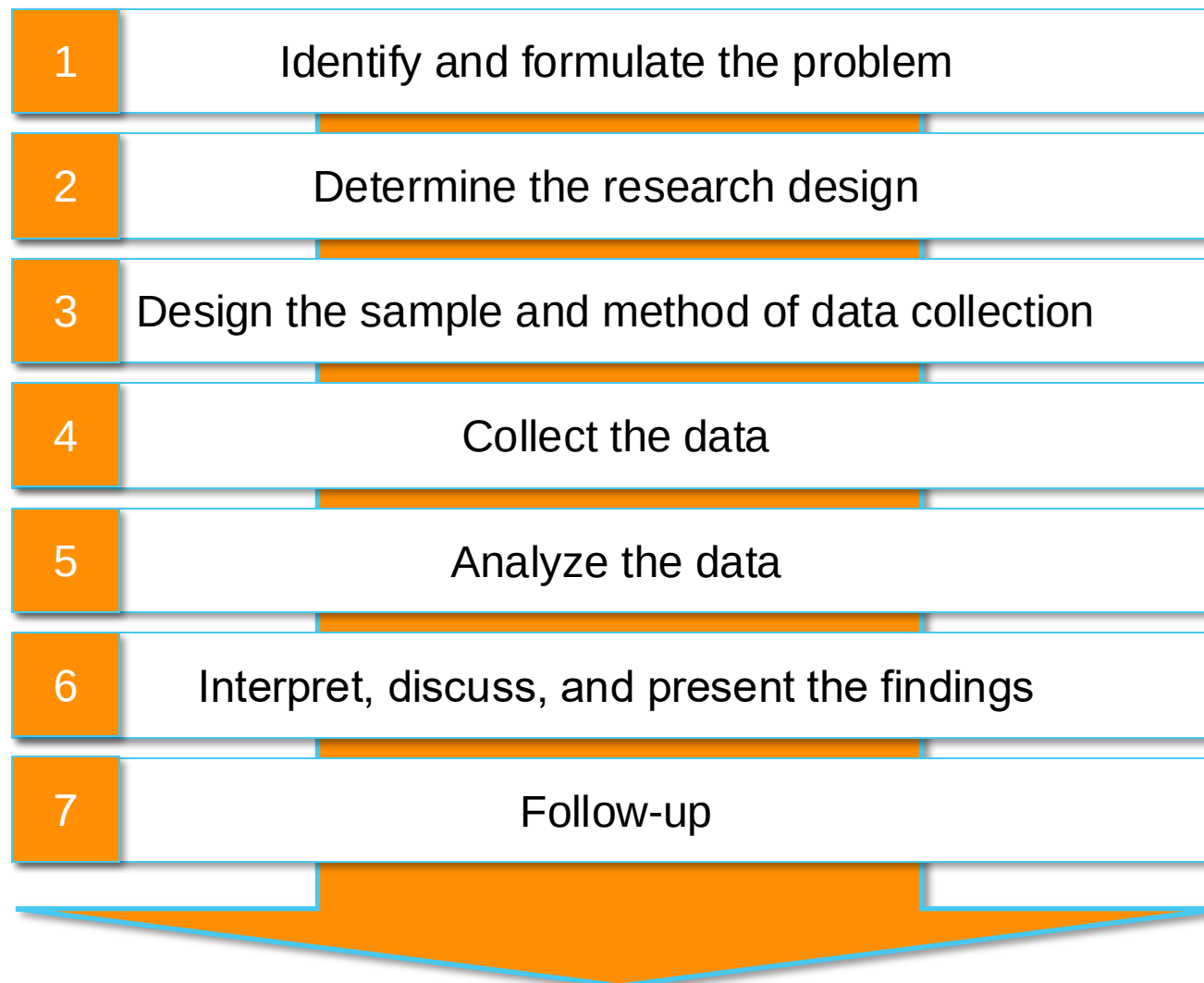
Questions?



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The Marketing Research Process

The Market Research Process



First Step: Identify and Formulate the Problem (the most important step!)



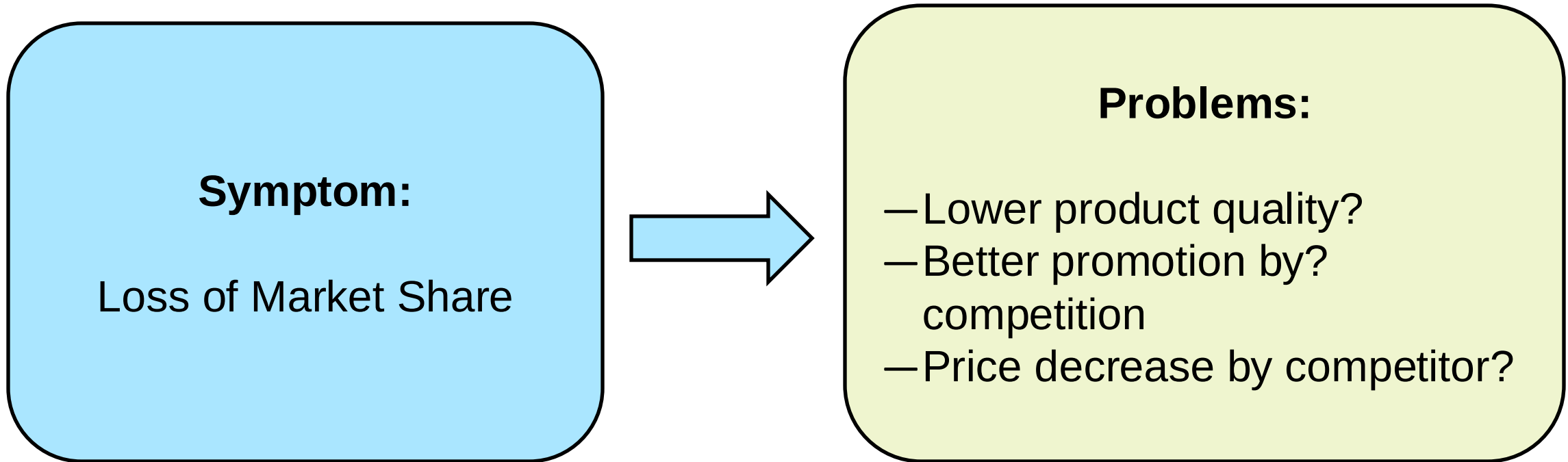
1. What? = Marketing Symptom

The *marketing symptom* can be a problem (decreasing sales figures, declining customer satisfaction, etc.), as well as an opportunity (emerging markets opportunities, access to new technology, etc.)

2. Why? = Marketing Problem

1. Ambiguous problems
(Uncertainty regarding the measures and leverages of problem solution)
2. Somewhat defined problems
(Uncertainty regarding the interaction of the measures)
3. Clearly defined problems
(Interaction of the measures and leverages is known, but the dimension is not clear)

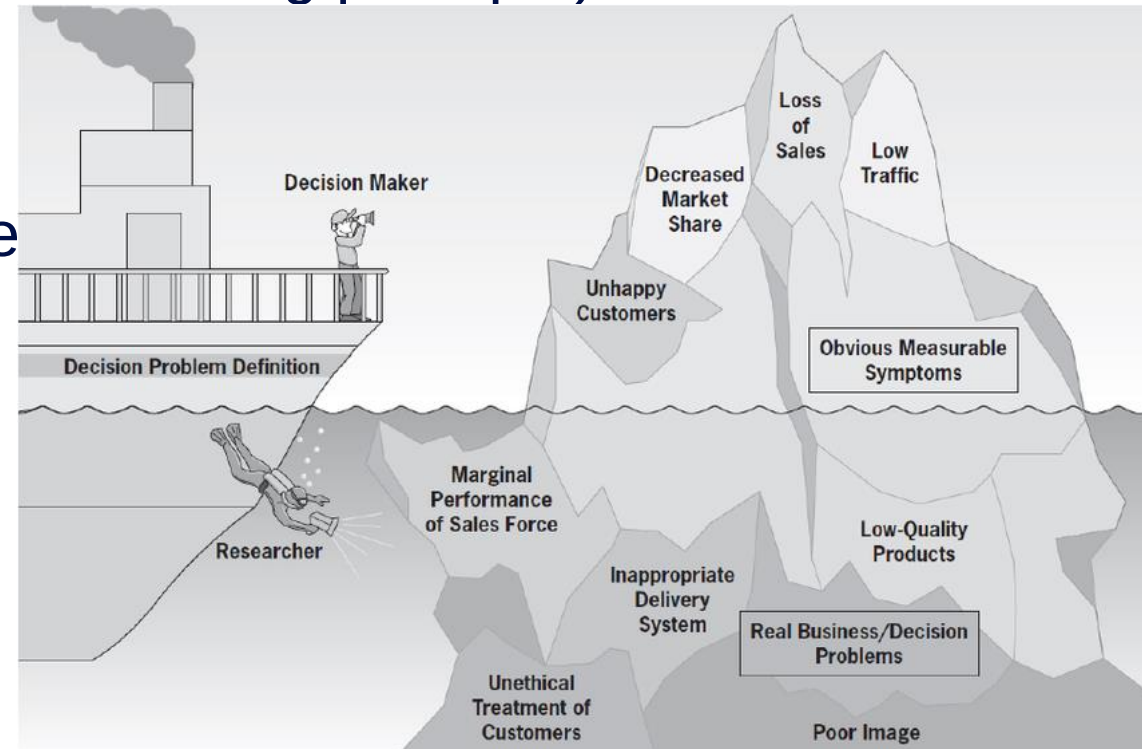
Example: First step



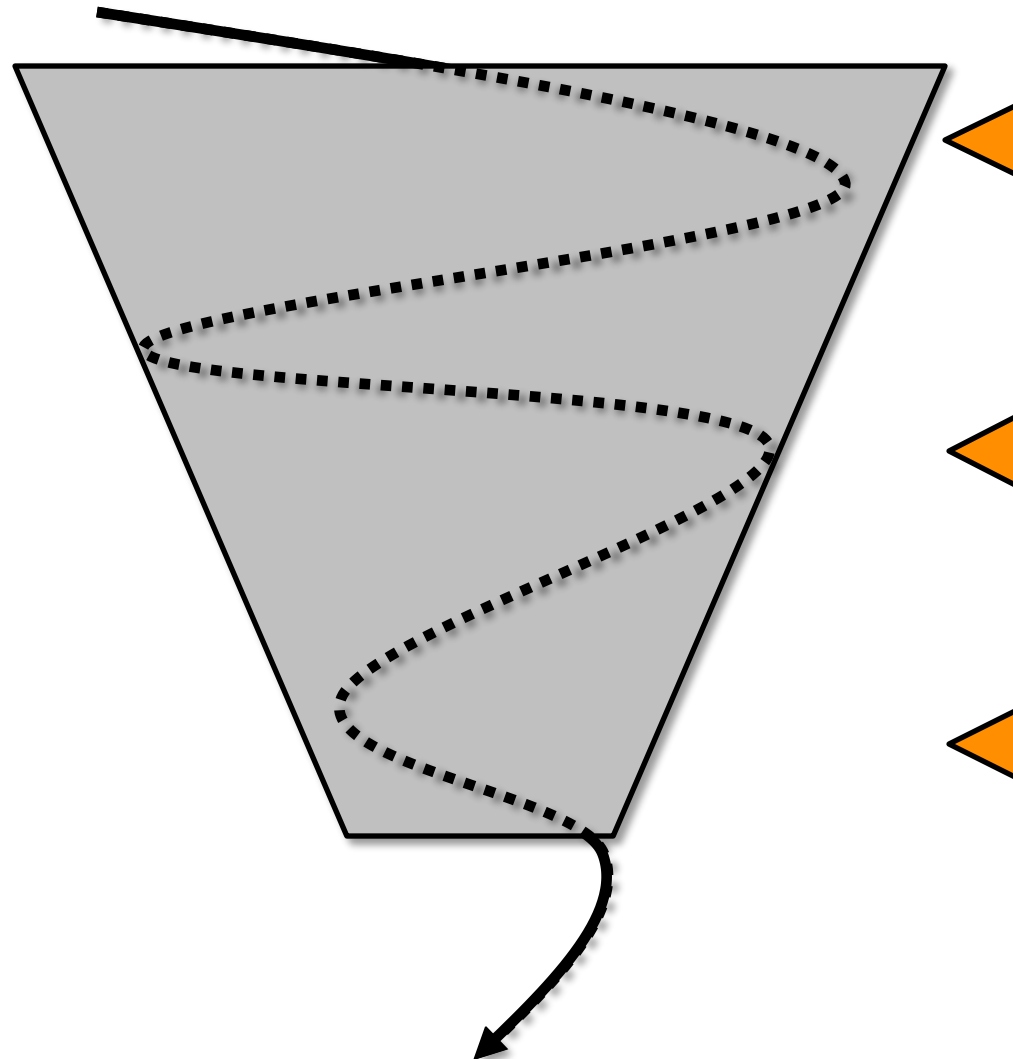
From symptoms to problem definition



- The management question may not be the marketing research question
- Symptoms may not be what they seem (i.e., the iceberg principle)
- Some questions cannot be answered
- Some questions are not politically acceptable
- Some decisions have already been taken
- Time/effort/resource constraints



Second Step: Determine the Research Design



Ambiguous problems:
Exploratory research
design

**Somewhat defined
problems:** Descriptive
research design

**Clearly defined
problems:** Causal
research design

Second Step: Which Research Design?

It depends on the type of problem.

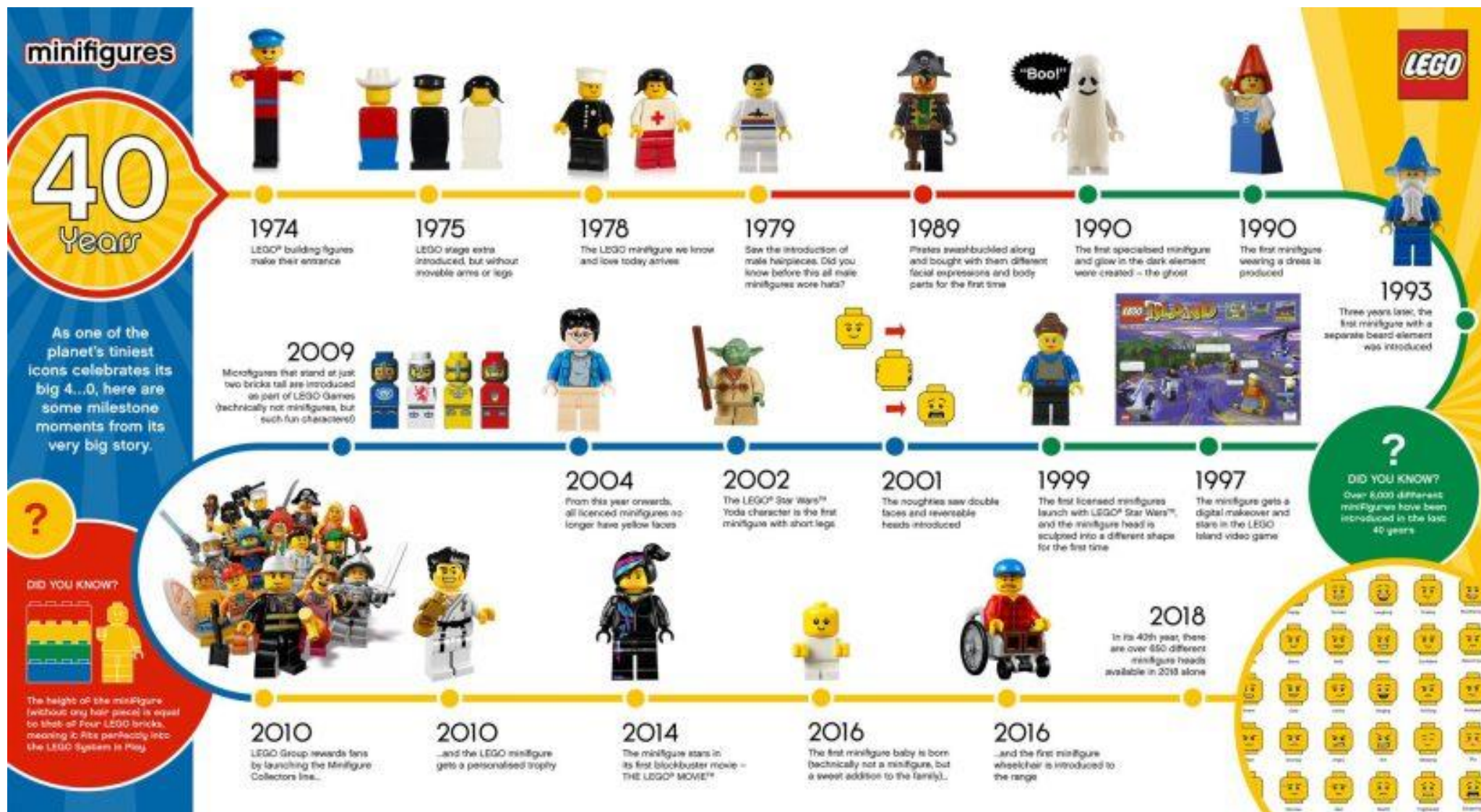
	Ambiguous	Somewhat defined	Clearly defined
	Exploratory research	Descriptive research	Causal Research
Uses	• Understand structure • Formulate problems precisely • Generate hypotheses • Develop measurement scales	• Describe customers or competitors • Understand market size • Segment markets • Measure performance (e.g., share of wallet, brand awareness)	• Uncover causality • Understand the performance effects of marketing mix elements

Steps 3-7

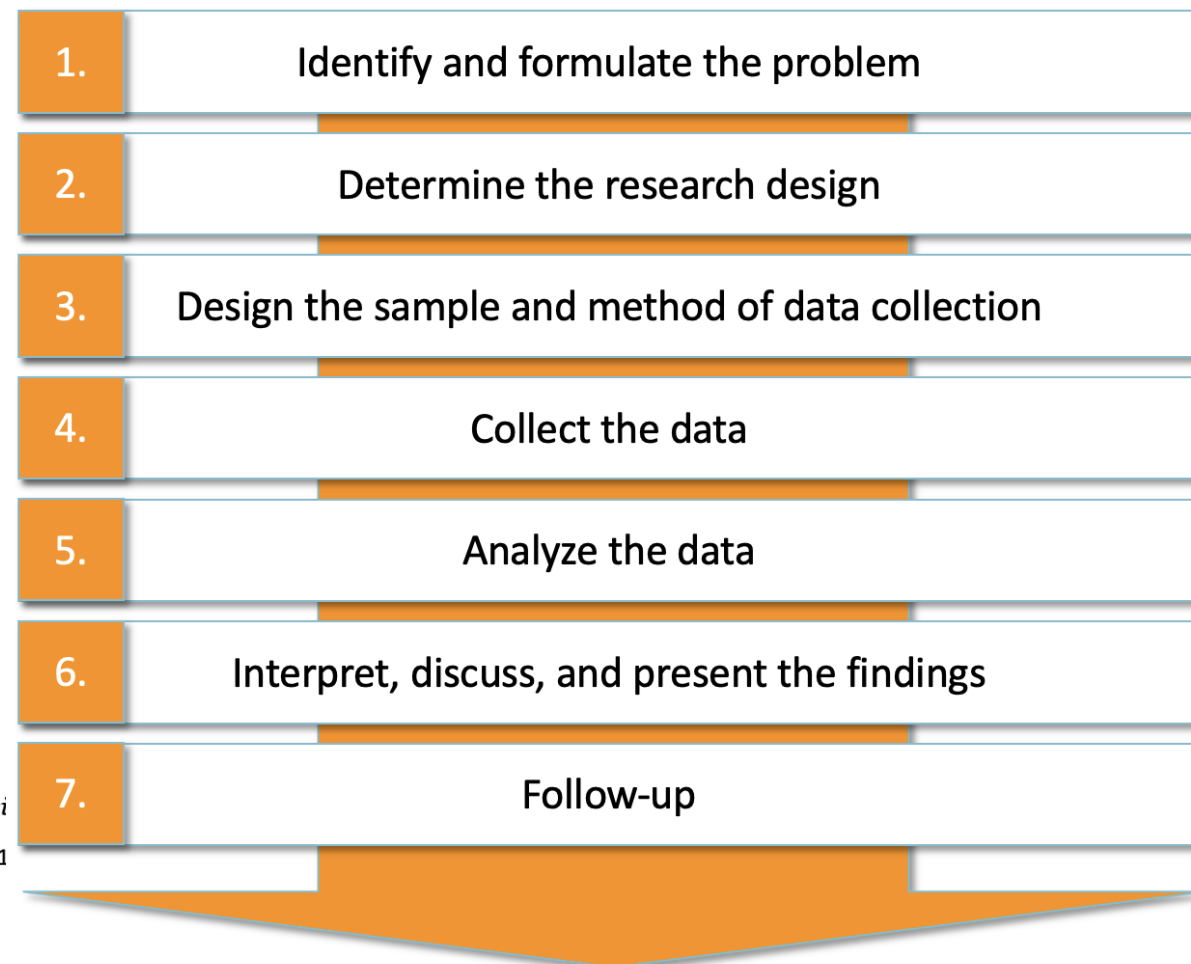
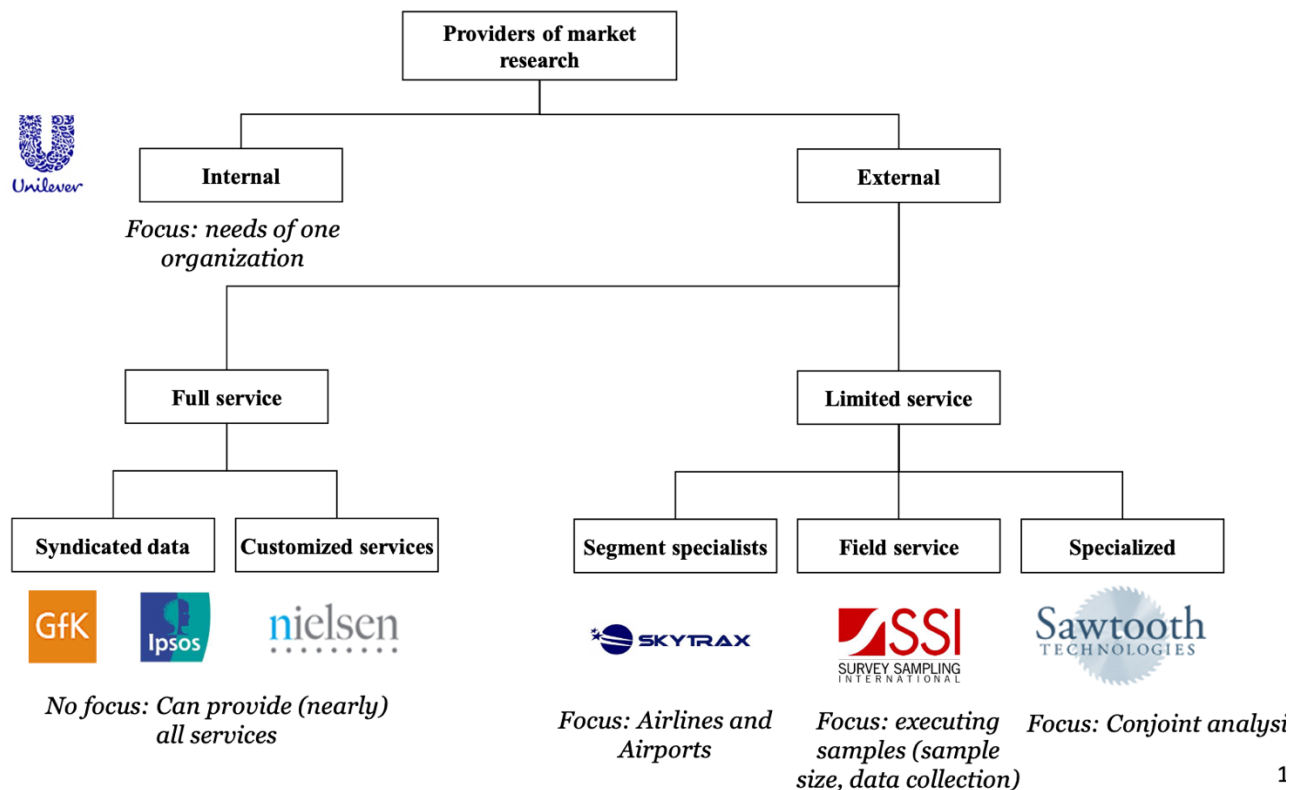


- **3rd Step: Design the sample and method of data collection**
- **4th Step: Collect the data**
- **5th Step: Analyze the data**
- **6th Step: Interpret, discuss, and present the findings**
- **7th Step: Follow-up**

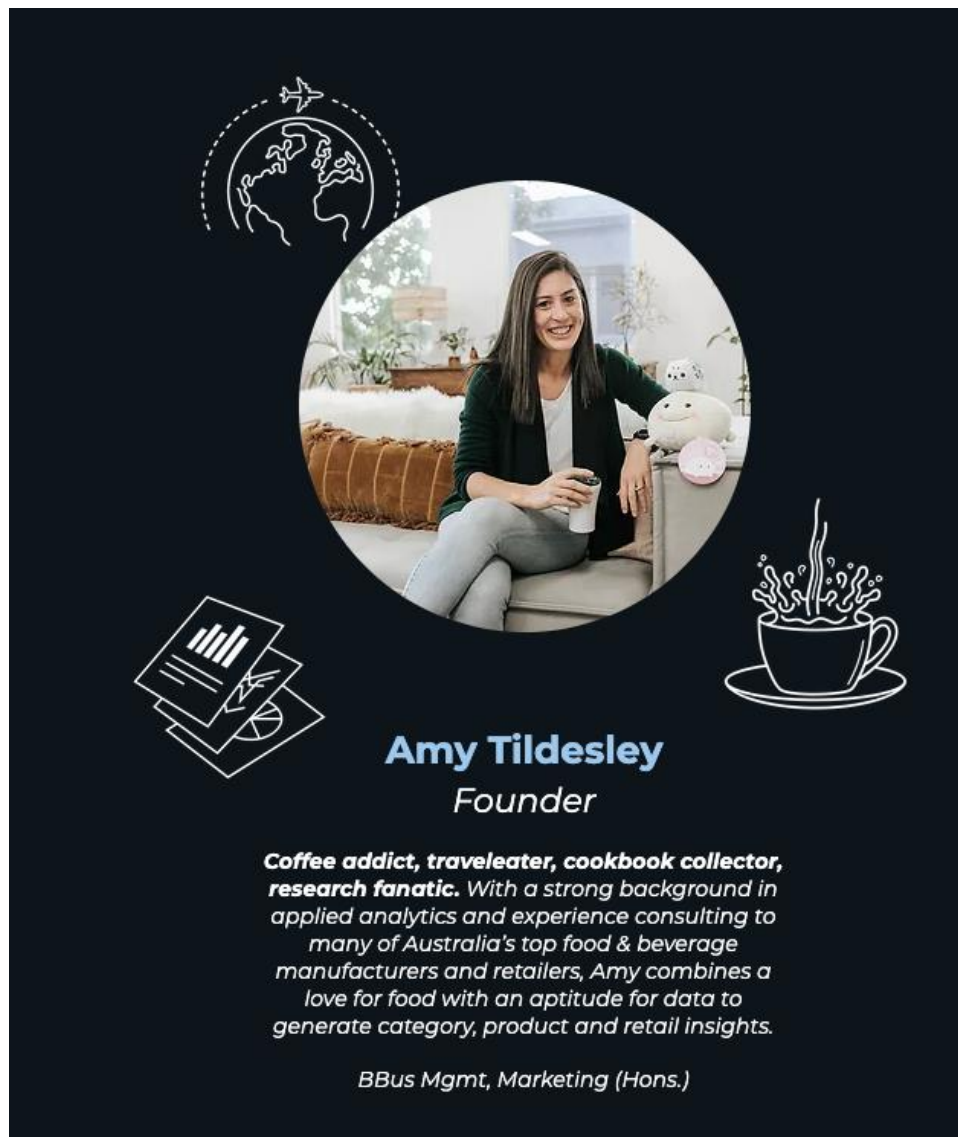
Sample project



Recap



This Week's Industry Expert

A dark blue rectangular graphic featuring a central circular photo of Amy Tildesley, a woman with long dark hair, smiling and holding a coffee cup. Surrounding the photo are four white line-art icons: a globe with an airplane (top left), a coffee cup with steam (bottom right), a stack of papers with a bar chart (bottom left), and a stylized plant (top right).

Amy Tildesley
Founder

Coffee addict, travel eater, cookbook collector, research fanatic. With a strong background in applied analytics and experience consulting to many of Australia's top food & beverage manufacturers and retailers, Amy combines a love for food with an aptitude for data to generate category, product and retail insights.

BBus Mgmt, Marketing (Hons.)

“How to respond to a project brief”

“Marketing research industry in AU - Landscape & Trends”